pass by, nets, laces, purses, etc., made in the prison. The two whom I saw there last were Crown debtors not cleared by the Insolvent Act. Now, this is not permitted.

At Christmas, felons chained together are permitted to go about; one of them carrying a sack or basket for food; another, a box for money.

COUNTY BRIDEWELL

MARLBOROUGH. A common workroom thirteen and a half feet by twelve and a half: a lodging-room for women twenty-three feet two inches by nine feet eight: another for men; this is thirteen and a half feet by ten; window nineteen inches by fifteen, not to the open air, but to the workroom, which has but one window. All these rooms are on the ground-floor; and by a sewer within doors, they are made very offensive, especially the men's night-room; in which, when I was there first, I saw one dying on the floor of the gaol-fever. The keeper told me that just before, one had died there, and another soon after his discharge. Upstairs are three rooms for those who pay 2s. 6d. a week. No court: no water accessible to prisoners: no straw. Allowance to petty offenders, none; felons, three halfpennyworth of bread a day and a pint of small beer. Keeper's salary lately raised from £20 to £50, to supply the prisoners with bread. The county pays the fees, 7s. 8d. at the discharge of every prisoner. (The fees were formerly, as in a table dated 1671, felons, £1 6s. 4d.; petty offenders, 14s. 4d., etc.). Licence for beer. A surgeon; his salary £10 10s. 0d. At my visits in 1775 and 1776, some prisoners were at work; but none in 1779. One of them said, with evident concern, "he had been there thirty weeks and had not earned one half-penny." In 1782, no employment. On asking the prisoners, if they desired to work; they readily answered in the affirmative. Two said, their wives had brought them wool, but the keeper would not permit them to spin it. I heard the justices had viewed the outside of this prison.

DORSETSHIRE

COUNTY BRIDEWELL

SHERBORNE. The justices have very judiciously provided for the relief of prisoners going to different quarter sessions. Their order, dated 12 April, 1774, is as follows:

Sherborn, Dorset. The great inhumanity that frequently happens unto the several prisoners—conveyed to the different quarter sessions to be tried, by the walking loaded with heavy irons, being taken into consideration—it is the resolution and order of this court that for the future the gaol-keeper and bridewell-keeper shall provide for one prisoner only a horse, for two or more a convenient cart or carriage for the conveying them: and to be allowed the sum of threepence per mile for one person; for two or more the sum of sixpence a mile, etc.

DEVONSHIRE

HIGH GAOL AT EXETER

This gaol is the property of John Denny Rolle, Esq., whose family had a grant of it from the Duchy of Cornwall: the late gaoler paid him rent £22 per annum. The house and court are too small: there is only one day-room for men and women felons; this is used as the chapel. Over it is the women's lodging-room. There are three rooms for fines, etc., one below and two above; that below is sometimes used for the condemned. There are three night-dungeons (about twenty feet by twelve) down three steps; the small window of one of them is under a staircase. These dungeons are the more unhealthy as at one part they are seven or eight feet underground. Mr. Rule, the late surgeon, told me that he was by contract excused from attending in the dungeons any prisoners that should have the gaol-fever. There are now two rooms for an infirmary, but the stairs that lead up to the men's rooms are intolerably bad: no bath. The court is paved with pebbles (flagstones would be much better). In it is an offensive sewer. At the top of the gaoler's house is an alarm bell. The prisoners formerly made cabbage-nets for twopence a dozen; and purses of different sorts from fourpence